bathroom, it means I haven't been drinking enough water and am in danger.)

Since I was told to catch the stone for analysis if I could, I had to urinate into a jar (when this was possible) and inspect it to see if I had caught anything. In this fashion, weeks went by. Sometimes I was in dull low-back pain, sometimes I was uncomfortable, but there was no agony such as that on the first day. 12

12 While I was in the hospital, American troops had reached the Chinese border, and virtually all of North Korea was under American control. The war looked over to me and it did to MacArthur, too, for he promised the soldiers they'd be home by Christmas. Unfortunately, on November 28, Chinese troops poured across the border and caught the overconfident Americans by surprise and sent them into headlong retreat.

Pregnancy

On November 29, 1950, I received a letter from Sprague de Camp. Catherine was pregnant again. She was forty-three years old at the time.

I sighed. In my more despondent moments over the problem of children, it seemed to me that everyone could have them, and did have them, except us.

Concerning my literary children, however, there was no problem. We drove to New York on December 1, and the next day I went to Greenberg's office and found him and his partner, David Kyle, placing covers on a number of copies of I, Robot

My second book!

I autographed a number of the books for Greenberg's use and then went to a bookshop where an "autographing party" was held. It was my first such affair and it was not exactly an exuberant success. About ten people bought books and I autographed them.

On December 3, Gertrude and I went to Newark to attend Mosko-witz's group, the Eastern Science Fiction Association. Ted Sturgeon was the speaker and talked about his story in the next issue of Galaxy. I was transfixed with horror. One of the gimmicks in his story was precisely mine in "Hostess." What's more, he had Derek and Verna as male and female characters, and I had Drake and Vera.

I felt this was going to make it impossible for Horace Gold to use "Hostess."